

My local area

Phonics focus

- One sound to one letter, e.g. consonants / **p** // **m** // **f** // **l** //
- One sound to two letters, e.g. 'ch' / **tʃ** / in *children* and 'sh' / **ʃ** / *fresh*
- Soft 'c' / **s** / *centre*
- Long vowel sound spelt with two letters 'ar' / **ɑ:** / *car, park*
- Blending two consonants 'f r' **fruit, fresh**
- Breaking words into syllables *li – bra – ry, mar – ket*

Additional materials

- [Pictures](#) (p.3) of a local market, food and fruit, library, school and children's centre and/or the pictures in [New to ESOL Topic 2, Unit 4](#)
- [Word cards](#) (p.4 and from [Topic 2, Unit 4](#)): market / library / park / children's centre / food / fruit / near / next to / opposite /
- [Other word cards as appropriate](#), e.g. There is / the / a / like / cheap / fresh / fruit / children / . /
- [Letter cards](#): cards with alphabet letters and individual graphemes
- [Text](#) (p.5)
- [Sentence strips](#) (from [Topic 2, Unit 4](#))
- [Template 12](#) - phoneme chart (for support)
- Sticky notes and mini whiteboards

Warmer: Introduce the topic: refer to 'New to ESOL' materials **Topic 2, Units 1 and 4** and discuss where the learners live, local amenities and the local area.

Suggested procedure

1. Show the pictures, check vocabulary and elicit/tell the story orally (Text p.5), checking understanding as you do so. Ask learners to re-tell the story. Focus on comprehension, especially 'near' 'next to' and 'opposite'.
2. Hold up the word cards, drill and check understanding. Ask learners to stick each word card on the correct picture, e.g. *park, library, children's centre, market, fruit, food*
3. Show the text (p.5) and read it aloud slowly, pointing to each word as you say it.
4. Break down the longer words into syllables and say them carefully, e.g. mar – ket, li – bra – ry, o - ppo – site, chil – dren. Encourage learners to clap or tap the syllables as you say them. Explain, if possible, about stressed and unstressed syllables, the 'schwa' and the differences between speaking and reading/spelling.
5. Focus on the initial /s/ in *centre*. Elicit any other words they know which have the same sound/spelling relationship, e.g. city, receipt, ceiling. Explain that most words beginning with the letter 'c' are pronounced with the hard sound /k/ as in *cat*.

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6. Practise blending the 'f' and 'r' in *fruit* and *fresh*.
7. Slowly read the text aloud with the learners (choral reading). Ask for volunteers to read it aloud, pointing to the words as they say them.
8. Give each learner a copy of the text to practise reading – in pairs or individually. Concept check as appropriate.
9. At any point during the reading of the text, focus on phonics: point to a word and sound it out or ask a learner to sound it out, e.g. n – e – x – t, f – r – e – sh.
10. Focus on an initial or final grapheme and elicit the sound, e.g. 'f' in *food*, *fruit* and *fresh*, 'i' in *like* and *library*, 'sh' in *fresh*, 'ch' in *children* and *cheap*.
11. Focus on the short vowel sound in *fresh* and *next*. Elicit other words learners know with the same sound/spelling pattern.

Activity 1: Say the words slowly and ask learners to select or copy the missing letters.

Activity 2: Learners say the words and select/copy the initial consonants.

Activity 3: Learners read the text aloud and select/copy the missing vowel letters.

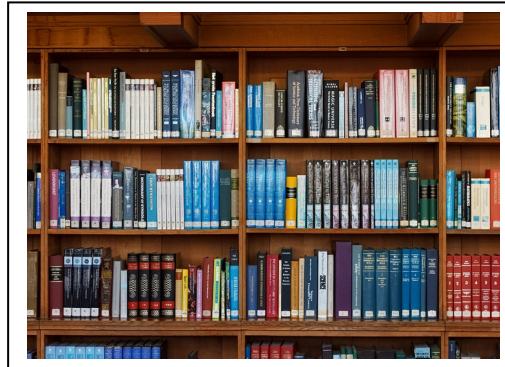
Activity 4: Learners say the words and insert the missing letters.

Further phonics practice activities

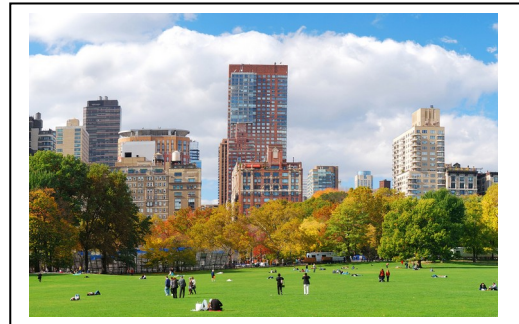
- Choose one-syllable words from the text (suitable for your learners) and put each grapheme on a sticky note – say the sounds as you build the word, e.g. n – e – x – t, f – r – e – sh, f – oo – d, p – ar – k, ch – ea – p.
- Make puzzles with one grapheme on each sticky note, e.g. ch ea p, m ar k e t, f r e sh, and ask learners to assemble them into words. Make sure you/the learners say the sounds as they put the words together.
- Hand out copies of the text. Choose a specific sound and ask learners to listen and highlight/underline the grapheme as you say it, e.g. 'f' (fruit, food, fresh) or 'n' (next, near)
- Learners listen and write the graphemes as you sound them out: f – r – e – sh, f – oo – d, n – e – x – t, p – ar – k. Alternatively, learners select the correct grapheme card as you say it.
- Elicit other known words which rhyme or which have the same sound/letter pattern and build up a list on the board, e.g. for 'oo' sound/letter pattern: b – oo – t, s – oo – n, r – oo – m; for 'ar' sound/letter pattern: d – ar – k, m – ar – k, c – ar, j – ar, f – ar. Use pictures for support.
- Work on syllables, e.g. child – ren, li – bra – ry, o – ppo – site. Learners say words slowly as they break them down into syllables. Note the schwa in all these words. Create sticky note puzzles based on the syllables.
- Use mini-whiteboards for phoneme, grapheme or spelling practice.

For more suggestions, see the 'Introduction to Phonics' section.

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Images from *New to ESOL* materials Topic 2, Unit 4



Free images from <https://pixabay.com/photos/farmers-market-berries-fruit-1311017/>



market	park
fruit	children's centre
food	library

My local area

There is a market near the library.

I like the market.

The food is cheap and fresh.

I like the fruit.

The park is next to the library.

**The children's centre is opposite
the park.**

Activity 1

... ood
... ruit
... resh

f

m ket
p k

ar

Activity 2.

There n ... xt e lib.
I like fr sh e

The ... ood is cheap and ... resh.

I like the ... ruit.

The ... ark is next to the library.

The children's centre is opposite the ... ark.

m m f f f p

Activity 3

There is a m ket near the library.

I like the m ket.

The food is cheap and fr ... sh.

I like the fruit.

The park is n ... xt to the library.

p

The children's c ... ntre is opposite the p.....k.

ar ar e e e ar

Activity 4

ch t n l d p sh t n

m	ar	k	e			
	i	b	r	a	r	y
f	oo					
	ea	p				
f	r	e				
f	r	ui				
	e	x	t			
c	e		t	re		
	ar	k				

Now choose a word from the text and create your own word box.
